



Comparative Proficiency Levels

English Learner Profiles

English learners have different levels of language proficiency. *Pearson Longman Cornerstone* scaffolds instruction for multiple levels of language proficiency, and helps each student move to the next level. This chart compares the different language proficiency leveling systems used throughout the United States. Find your leveling system and use the lesson instruction in your Teacher's Edition that is appropriate for your students.

Levels of Proficiency	Beginning	Early Intermediate
	Level I	Level II
	Entering	Beginning
	Beginning	Intermediate
Characteristics of the English Language Learner	• May be unfamiliar with sounds, rhythms, or patterns in English • Respond by pointing, gesturing, or drawing • Can use simple yes/no responses or one- to two-word answers • Read simple language that they have already heard • Write labels, patterned sentences, or short cloze sentences	• May understand more details in spoken English • Use longer phrases and sentences with better grammar • Write for a variety of purposes using models • Can read independently after oral previews
What They Can Do: Performance Indicators	• Listen • Point • Illustrate • Match • Choose	• Name • List and group • Categorize • Label • Demonstrate
Teaching Strategies	• Provide opportunities for active listening and visuals • Model language with songs and chants • Pair students with more proficient speakers • Ask yes/no questions; require responses of one or two words • Use manipulatives and pictures • Provide writing frames	• Allow students to make personal connections with the material • Structure group discussion time • Ask open-ended questions and then model, expand, restate, and enrich student language • Allow students opportunities to create language for a variety of purposes and audiences

Intermediate	Early Advanced	Advanced
Level III	Level IV	Level V
Developing	Expanding	Bridging
Intermediate	Advanced	Advanced High
• Participate in discussions about academic content • Can use higher-order language to describe or persuade • Write narratives and expository text • Use vocabulary with more accuracy and correctness	• Have a deeper understanding of everyday language, including idioms • Use more extensive vocabulary and produce language with fewer grammatical errors • Use standard forms when writing • Produce writing about varied topics	• Use more complex and varied grammatical structures and vocabulary • Read texts appropriate for grade level • Write about a variety of topics on grade level • Begin to self-monitor and correct as they read and write
• Compare and contrast • Recall and retell • Summarize • Explain	• Analyze • Debate • Justify	• All performance indicators
• Use graphic organizers to prepare students for reading and to discuss selections • Promote academic concepts and vocabulary with nonfictional texts, magazines, newspapers, and so on • Conference with students about writing to point out areas of progress and areas for improvement	• Structure discussion for the group • Provide reference materials for students and guide them with the research • Introduce more variety of literary forms • Provide opportunities for more variation in writing assignments	• Provide opportunities for students to publish their writing for others to read • Increase students' production of language through drama and music • Continue to make strong links between content-area materials and literacy activities